

How to Read This Guide

Pages 4–6 of this handout contain **purine heat maps** — colour-coded food tables that show exactly how much purine is in each Filipino food item and whether it is safe, limited, or avoided on a gout-friendly diet. This page explains how to interpret them.

WHAT ARE PURINES — AND WHY DO THEY MATTER?

Purines are natural compounds found in many foods. When your body breaks them down, the end product is **uric acid**. If uric acid builds up faster than your kidneys can excrete it, it crystallises in joints and soft tissue — causing the painful swelling of a gout flare. In CKD, the kidneys are already less efficient at clearing uric acid, so dietary management becomes especially important.

THE COLOUR-CODING SYSTEM — PAGES 4–6

Colour	Risk level	Purine range	What it means for you
RED	Avoid	>300 mg / 100 g	Skip entirely or eat only once per month at most. These push uric acid significantly above target.
ORANGE	Strictly limit	150–300 mg / 100 g	Maximum 1–2 × per week, small portion (½ cup or less). Combine with high-fluid intake that day.
AMBER	Moderate caution	80–150 mg / 100 g	Up to 3–4 × per week in normal portions. Monitor your uric acid if eating regularly.
GREEN	Safe — eat freely	<80 mg / 100 g	No purine restriction. Form the foundation of every meal. These are your go-to foods.
BLUE	Alcohol — avoid	Variable	Beer, brandy, and distilled spirits block uric acid excretion regardless of purine content. See page 5.

HOW TO READ THE TABLE COLUMNS

Column	What it shows	How to use it
Food Item (Filipino / English)	The Filipino common name comes first so you can identify it at the market or table.	Match the food you are about to eat.
Purines mg / serving	Purine content in a typical Filipino single serving (e.g., 1 cup, 1 piece, 100 g).	Add up your servings across the day. Stay below 400 mg total.
Purines mg / 100 g	A standardised reference weight — lets you compare foods fairly regardless of portion.	Useful when buying packaged foods or adjusting portion size.
Risk	A one-word summary of the colour category (Avoid / High / Moderate / Low / Safe).	Quick scan without looking at numbers.

YOUR DAILY PURINE BUDGET

Patient type	Daily purine target	Protein target	Note
General adult (no gout / CKD)	< 600 mg/day	0.8 g/kg/day	No restriction; avoid excess organ meat and shellfish.
Hyperuricaemia without gout	< 500 mg/day	0.8–1.0 g/kg/day	Reduce if UA persistently > 8 mg/dL.
Established gout (not on medication)	< 400 mg/day	0.8 g/kg/day	Diet alone lowers UA by ~1–2 mg/dL.
Gout on febuxostat / allopurinol	< 500 mg/day	0.8 g/kg/day	Medication does the heavy lifting; diet prevents spikes.
CKD Stage 1–3 with gout	< 400 mg/day	0.8 g/kg/day	Monitor K ⁺ — some low-purine foods are high-potassium.
CKD Stage 4–5 / Dialysis with gout	< 400 mg/day	Per nephrologist	Protein and potassium restrictions may override purine targets.

■ Diet alone typically reduces serum uric acid by 1–2 mg/dL. If your target is < 6 mg/dL (or < 5 mg/dL in CKD), medication (febuxostat or allopurinol) is almost always required alongside dietary changes — see page 6 for the medication reference.

Uric Acid Targets & Medication Reference

Use this page alongside the food tables on pages 4–6. Diet controls purine load; medication controls uric acid synthesis and excretion. Both are usually needed to reach target in patients with established gout or CKD.

SERUM URIC ACID TARGETS — TREAT-TO-TARGET APPROACH				
Patient Group	Target UA	Rationale	Monitoring	
No gout (prevention)	< 7.0 mg/dL (men) < 6.0 mg/dL (women)	Saturation point of urate at body temperature.	Annual UA with metabolic panel.	
Established gout (no tophi)	< 6.0 mg/dL	Below this level, monosodium urate crystals dissolve over months.	UA every 2–4 weeks until target, then every 6 months.	
Gout with tophi or frequent flares	< 5.0 mg/dL	Lower target accelerates tophus resolution.	UA every 4 weeks until target, then every 6 months.	
CKD Stage 1–3 with gout	< 6.0 mg/dL	Standard target; renal dosing for medications applies.	UA + eGFR + creatinine every 3 months.	
CKD Stage 4–5 / Dialysis with gout	< 6.0 mg/dL (if tolerated)	Febuxostat preferred over allopurinol in severe CKD.	Discuss target and monitoring frequency with your nephrologist.	
Asymptomatic hyperuricaemia (UA > 9 mg/dL)	Consider < 6.0 mg/dL	KDIGO 2024 recommends treatment if UA > 9 mg/dL with CKD progression.	Reassess every 6 months.	

MEDICATIONS FOR GOUT — CKD DOSING & NOTES				
Medication	Purpose	Usual dose	CKD notes	Local notes (PH)
Febuxostat (Feburic®)	Urate-lowering (XO inhibitor)	40–80 mg once daily	No dose adjustment needed until eGFR < 15. Preferred over allopurinol in CKD Stage 3b–5.	Covered by PhilHealth Z-Benefit for gout with CKD. Available branded and generic.
Allopurinol	Urate-lowering (XO inhibitor)	100 mg/day; titrate by 100 mg q4wks to target	Reduce in CKD: eGFR 10–50 → 100–200 mg/day; eGFR < 10 → 100 mg every 2 days.	Cheapest option. Risk of DRESS syndrome — stop immediately if rash appears.
Colchicine (acute flare)	Anti-inflammatory (flare prevention)	0.5–0.6 mg twice daily for prophylaxis; 1.2 mg then 0.6 mg 1 hr later for acute flare	Reduce to once daily if eGFR 30–60. Avoid if eGFR < 10 or on dialysis.	Widely available. Do NOT combine with clarithromycin or cyclosporine — toxicity risk.
Naproxen / Mefenamic acid (acute flare only)	NSAID — anti-inflammatory	Short course only (3–5 days)	AVOID in CKD Stage 3b and above — accelerates kidney decline and raises BP.	Common OTC in Philippines — patients often self-medicate. Counsel against this.
Prednisone / Methylprednisolone (acute flare)	Corticosteroid — anti-inflammatory	30–40 mg/day × 3–5 days, taper	Safe in CKD; watch blood sugar in diabetics.	Used when colchicine and NSAIDs are contraindicated.
Probenecid	Uricosuric — increases UA excretion	500 mg twice daily	Contraindicated if eGFR < 30.	Rarely used in Filipino CKD patients. Ensure high fluid intake (> 2 L/day).

WHEN TO CONTACT YOUR DOCTOR OR GO TO THE ER	
Situation	Action
Sudden severe joint pain, swelling, warmth (especially big toe, ankle, knee)	Take colchicine as prescribed. If no relief in 24 hrs, call clinic.
Skin rash within 3 months of starting allopurinol	STOP allopurinol immediately. Go to ER — possible DRESS syndrome.
BP > 180/110 mmHg during a flare	Go to ER. NSAIDs worsen hypertension and kidney function.

Joint swelling with fever > 38.5°C	Go to ER — rule out septic arthritis (an emergency, not a gout flare).
UA > 10 mg/dL on repeat testing despite medication	Schedule a consultation. Dose titration or medication switch needed.

Building Your Gout-Friendly Filipino Meal

The food tables on pages 4–5 tell you what each food scores. This section shows you **how to put a full day of Filipino eating together** — which patterns protect you, which patterns trigger flares, and how to alkalisе your urine to help clear uric acid faster.

DAILY MEAL TEMPLATE

BREAKFAST
• Sinangag (garlic fried rice) — 1 cup • Itlog (egg, scrambled or boiled) — 1–2 pcs • Toyo-calamansi dip (small amount) • Kamatis / ensaladang talong • 1 glass of water or low-fat milk
MORNING SNACK
• Banana or papaya — 1 pc • Low-fat yogurt — 1 small cup • 1–2 glasses of water
LUNCH
• Rice — 1 cup (plain) • Lean chicken adobo (skinless) — 1 pc • Pinakbet or ginisang gulay — 1 cup • Sabaw (broth) — 1 bowl • 2 glasses of water
AFTERNOON SNACK
• Kamote or saging na saba — 1 pc • Water or fresh buko juice — 1 glass
DINNER
• Rice — 1 cup • Tilapia / bangus (steamed/grilled) — 1 slice • Monggo gulay — ½ cup (amber; balance with vegetables) • Sayote or upo soup — 1 bowl • 2 glasses of water

HIDDEN TRIGGER PATTERNS

THE PIKA-PIKA TRAP
Pulutan sessions with beer, bagoong, dilis, tokwa, mani at gabi — every item on the table is high-purine, and alcohol blocks uric acid excretion. A single pika-pika session can raise UA by 2–3 mg/dL the next morning.
SINIGANG NA BABOY / BULALO
The bone broth concentrates purines released from pork ribs and marrow. Switch to sinigang na isda (tilapia) or sinigang na manok and drink the sabaw sparingly.
CANNED SARDINES / TUYO DAILY
Extremely high purine content (>300 mg/100 g). Many patients eat this daily as a cheap protein source — this alone can prevent reaching UA target. See page 4 for alternatives.
SOFTDRINKS DURING FLARES
Fructose in softdrinks stimulates uric acid production independently of purines. Avoid all sugar-sweetened beverages, especially during and after a flare.
ORGAN MEAT (GOTO, DINUGUAN, PAPAITAN)
Liver, kidneys, brain, and intestines have the highest purine density of any food group. Even small portions in a stew significantly raise the purine load.
FLUID & ALKALINE TIPS
Target 2.5–3 L of fluids per day
Dilutes uric acid in blood and urine. Water and buko juice are best. Avoid softdrinks and beer.
Alkaline foods at every meal
Kamatis, pechay, sayote, upo, malunggay, calamansi juice — these raise urine pH and increase urate solubility. See page 5, vegetable section.
Vitamin C 500 mg daily (with physician approval)
Mild uricosuric effect (~0.5 mg/dL reduction). Found in calamansi, guava, and papaya. Supplement only if diet is insufficient.
Limit coffee to 2 cups/day
Moderate coffee consumption is associated with lower UA. Avoid 3-in-1 mixes — excess sugar offsets the benefit.

■ This guide is for general patient education. Individual dietary advice depends on your eGFR, serum potassium, and medication regimen. Consult your physician before making major dietary changes — some high-potassium vegetables safe for gout may need limiting in CKD Stage 4–5.

DAILY PURINE TARGET: <400 mg/day (gout) | <200 mg/day (severe or tophaceous gout)**Plant-based purines (vegetables, beans) DO NOT raise flare risk — animal-derived purines do.**

Source: FNRI-Philippines. USDA. ACR 2020. KDIGO 2024. Values are approximate per typical Filipino serving.

Food Item (Filipino / English)	Serving	Purines	mg/day target	Risk
ORGAN MEATS (LAMMAN-LOOB) — single biggest risk category; avoid entirely				
Sweetbreads (thymus/pancreas)	100g	~825	206%	EXTREME
Atay ng baka / beef liver	100g	~550	138%	EXTREME
Bato ng baka / beef kidney	100g	~510	127%	EXTREME
Dinuguan (pork blood stew)	1 cup	~480	120%	EXTREME
Atay ng manok / chicken liver	100g	~470	118%	EXTREME
Goto / tripe (callos)	100g	~470	118%	EXTREME
Utak / brain	100g	~360	90%	EXTREME
Kasim / balun-balunan / gizzard	100g	~280	70%	EXTREME
Isaw ng manok / chicken intestines	2 sticks (~50g)	~250	62%	EXTREME
Bituka ng baboy / pork intestines	100g	~230	57%	VERY HIGH
Betamax (pork/chicken blood)	1 stick (~50g)	~190	48%	VERY HIGH
Puso ng manok / chicken heart	100g	~170	42%	HIGH
SEAFOOD & FISH — small fish, shellfish, dried/fermented = highest risk				
Sardinas (canned, with bones)	1/2 can (100g)	~480	120%	EXTREME
Dilis / dried anchovies (bilad)	30g	~340	85%	EXTREME
Tuyo / dried salted fish	30g	~290	72%	EXTREME
Bagoong alamang / shrimp paste	1 tbsp (15g)	~250	62%	EXTREME
Tahong / green mussels	100g	~290	72%	EXTREME
Talaba / oysters	100g	~290	72%	EXTREME
Tuna (fresh, grilled)	100g	~290	72%	EXTREME
Hipon / sugpo / shrimp, prawns	100g	~265	66%	VERY HIGH
Galunggong / mackerel scad	100g	~250	62%	VERY HIGH
Bagoong isda / fermented fish paste	1 tbsp (15g)	~220	55%	VERY HIGH
Hibe / dried small shrimp	1 tbsp (10g)	~200	50%	VERY HIGH
Pusit / squid	100g	~190	48%	HIGH
Alimasag / alimango / crab	100g	~150	38%	HIGH
Bangus / milkfish (fresh, grilled)	100g	~165	41%	HIGH
Tilapia (grilled)	100g	~120	30%	MODERATE
Cream dory / pangasius	100g	~95	24%	MODERATE
MEAT, POULTRY & PROCESSED MEATS				
Lechon kawali / liempo (pork belly)	100g	~145	36%	HIGH
Adobong manok / chicken adobo	100g	~140	35%	HIGH
Beef brisket / tapa / karne	100g	~135	34%	HIGH
Chicken breast, boiled (no skin)	100g	~135	34%	HIGH
Tocino / longganisa / hotdog	100g	~110	28%	HIGH
Spam / corned beef (canned)	100g	~110	28%	HIGH
Pork shoulder / kasim (inihaw)	100g	~130	32%	HIGH

GOUT & URIC ACID IN CKD — SAFE & MODERATE PURINE FOODS + COMPLETE MEAL GUID

W. G. M. Rivero, MD, FPCP, DPSN | PRC 0105184 | williamriveromd.com | 2025

GREEN (SAFE) < 50 mg/serving | TEAL (LOW) 50-100 mg | AMBER (MODERATE) 100-200 mg

Plant-based purines do NOT raise flare risk in modern studies. Prioritize eliminating organ meats, shellfish, beer, and HFCS drinks.

Food Item (Filipino / English)	Serving	Purines	mg/day target	Risk
VEGETABLES & LEGUMES — safe despite measurable purines (plant purines ≠ flare risk)				
Upo / bottle gourd	1 cup cooked	~5 ↕	1%	SAFE
Sayote / chayote	1 cup cooked	~10 ↕	2%	SAFE
Repolyo / cabbage	1 cup cooked	~12 ↓	3%	SAFE
Talong / eggplant	1 cup cooked	~14 ↓	4%	SAFE
Labanos / white radish	1 cup cooked	~15 ↓	4%	SAFE
Kamatis / tomato	1 medium	~15 ↓	4%	SAFE
Pipino / cucumber	1 cup	~10 ↕	2%	SAFE
Kangkong (boiled, water discarded)	1 cup cooked	~40 ●	10%	SAFE
Pechay / bok choy	1 cup cooked	~30 ●	8%	SAFE
Ampalaya / bitter melon	1 cup cooked	~35 ●	9%	SAFE
Kalabasa / squash	1 cup cooked	~75 ●	19%	SAFE
Asparagus	1 cup cooked	~75 ●	19%	SAFE
Kabute / mushroom (fresh)	1 cup cooked	~90 ●	22%	SAFE
Spinach / alugbati	1 cup cooked	~60 ●	15%	SAFE
Malunggay / moringa	1/2 cup cooked	~55 ●	14%	SAFE
Munggo / mung beans (cooked)	1 cup	~135 ●	34%	MODERATE
Garbanzos / chickpeas (cooked)	1/2 cup	~85 ●	21%	SAFE
Tokwa / tofu (firm)	100g	~70 ●	18%	SAFE
GRAINS, EGGS, DAIRY & FRUITS — foundation of a gout-friendly diet				
Kanin / white rice (1 cup)	1 cup cooked	~10 ↕	2%	SAFE
Pandesal / white bread	2 pieces	~12 ↓	3%	SAFE
Bihon / rice noodles	1 cup cooked	~10 ↕	2%	SAFE
Pasta / macaroni (cooked)	1 cup cooked	~15 ↓	4%	SAFE
Mais / corn (boiled)	1 ear	~45 ●	11%	SAFE
Itlog / whole egg	1 large	~5 ↕	1%	SAFE
Puti ng itlog / egg white	2 whites	~2 ↕	0%	SAFE
Gatas / low-fat milk	1 cup (240mL)	~15 ↓	4%	SAFE
Yogurt (plain, low-fat)	1 cup	~20 ↓	5%	SAFE
Mansanas / apple	1 medium	~9 ↕	2%	SAFE
Peras / pear	1 medium	~8 ↕	2%	SAFE
Papaya (ripe)	1 cup	~8 ↕	2%	SAFE
Saging / banana	1 medium	~8 ↕	2%	SAFE
Seresa / cherries (fresh)	10-12 pieces	~5 ↕	1%	PROTECTIVE
Calamansi (fruit)	3-5 pieces	~4 ↕	1%	PROTECTIVE
BEVERAGES — beer and HFCS drinks are the biggest hidden drivers				
Beer (any / lahat ng klase)	1 bottle (330mL)	Doubles flare risk	Doubles	EXTREME
Gin / lambanog / brandy / whiskey	1 shot (45mL)	Blocks UA excretion	Blocks U	EXTREME
Coke / Pepsi / Royal (HFCS)	1 can (330mL)	+0.3-0.5 mg/dL UA	+0.3-0.5	EXTREME
Softdrink kahit anong klase	500mL bottle	HFCS → urate	HFCS →	VERY HIGH
Sweetened milk-tea / frappuccino	1 large (500mL)	Fructose + sugar	Fructose	HIGH
Tang / Zest-O / powdered juices	1 glass	Concentrated fructose	Concent	HIGH
Fruit smoothie (mango/banana)	1 cup	Natural fructose	Natural f	MODERATE
Wine (red or white)	1 small glass	Less than beer/spirits	Less tha	MODERATE
Sports drink (Gatorade, Pocari)	500mL bottle	Sugar raises urate	Sugar ra	MODERATE
Brewed coffee (black)	1-3 cups/day	Lowers UA long-term	Lowers U	PROTECTIVE
Plain water	2.5-3 L/day	Improves excretion	Improve	PROTECTIVE
Low-fat milk / plain yogurt	1 cup	Lowers UA (orotic acid)	Lowers U	PROTECTIVE
Calamansi juice (unsweetened)	1 glass	Vitamin C → mild uricosuric	Vitamin	PROTECTIVE
Tart cherry juice (unsweetened)	1/2 cup	Anti-inflammatory	Anti-infl	PROTECTIVE

GOUT & URIC ACID IN CKD — HIDDEN TRIGGERS, MEDICATIONS & FLARE MANAGEMENT

W. G. M. Rivero, MD, FPCP, DPSN | PRC 0105184 | williamriveromd.com | 2025

HIDDEN URIC ACID DRIVERS IN FILIPINO FOOD & DAILY LIFE

HFCS Softdrinks (biggest hidden trigger):

Coke, Pepsi, Royal, Sprite, sweetened iced teas, energy drinks, store-bought milk-tea, Tang, Zest-O. HFCS → fructose → direct uric acid synthesis in liver. One 500mL bottle raises UA by 0.3-0.5 mg/dL within hours — enough to trigger a flare.

Hidden seafood & bagoong:

Bagoong alamang/isda in kare-kare, pinakbet, dipping sauce. Patis as finishing sauce. Hibe/dried shrimp in lugaw, palabok, tikoy. Sardines/anchovies in pasta. Anchovy paste hidden in Worcestershire sauce, Maggi seasoning, oyster sauce. Knorr/Maggi bouillon cubes =

Cooking broth (sabaw) trap:

Purines leach from bones and meat into the broth of nilaga, sinigang, bulalo, bone broth. Eat the meat in measured portions. SKIP THE BROTH entirely. The broth of bulalo is one of the highest-purine liquids in Filipino cooking.

Medications that raise uric acid:

Thiazide diuretics (HCTZ in Co-Diovan, Co-Aprovel) — #1 drug-induced gout cause. Loop diuretics (furosemide, torsemide). Low-dose aspirin 81mg. Cyclosporine/tacrolimus (transplant). Niacin (high-dose). Beta-blockers (metoprolol, atenolol). Do NOT stop cardiac meds without

Dehydration & lifestyle traps:

Heat, El Niño conditions, gym sessions, food poisoning: any rapid dehydration can trigger within 24h. Crash diets, fasting, ketogenic diets: ketone competition for UA excretion. Big blowout meals (hoodle fight, lechon party): days' worth of purines at once. Weekend binge drinking:

MEDICATIONS FOR GOUT — FLARE TREATMENT VS. LONG-TERM PREVENTION

Medication	Purpose	CKD Notes	Local Name (PH)
Febuxostat 80mg OD	Long-term UA lowering (preferred in CKD)	Dose adjustment until eGFR <15. Take daily. NO uric acid free, Aggrenox	Febuxostat
Allopurinol 100-300mg	Long-term UA lowering (alternative)	Dose-reduce in CKD. Check HLA-B*5801 first. Generic. No uric acid free, Aggrenox	Allopurinol
Colchicine 0.5mg	Flare treatment + prophylaxis when starting ULT	Start low, titrate within 12-24h. Reduce dose if liver or kidney issues. Generic. No uric acid free, Aggrenox	Colchicine
Prednisone / Methylpred	Acute flare (when NSAIDs contraindicated)	Preferred in CKD, elderly, or PUD. Short course. Generic. No uric acid free, Aggrenox	Prednisone / Methylpred
Naproxen / Indomethacin	Acute flare ONLY (NOT for CKD patients)	Avoid in CKD, heart failure, or peptic ulcer. Generic. No uric acid free, Aggrenox	Naproxen / Indomethacin

DO NOT start febuxostat/allopurinol during an active flare — wait until fully resolved (2-4 weeks).

When starting ULT: prescribe colchicine 0.5mg OD for 3-6 months to prevent paradoxical flares (crystal mobilization).

WHAT TO DO DURING A GOUT ATTACK — 4-STEP PROTOCOL

- Act within 12-24 hours:** Start anti-inflammatory medication IMMEDIATELY at first sign. Colchicine or prednisone (from your doctor's rescue kit). Do NOT
- Rest & ice:** Rest the affected joint. Elevate it above heart level. Apply ice wrapped in towel for 20-30 min, several times daily. Even bedsheets pressure
- Drink 3 liters of water today:** Flush uric acid through the kidneys. Avoid alcohol completely. Avoid HFCS drinks and sweet juices. Plain water, black co
- Do NOT stop your febuxostat/allopurinol:** Stopping and restarting ULT causes uric acid fluctuations that prolong the current flare and trigger additio

SMART SWAPS — HIGH-PURINE → LOWER-PURINE FILIPINO ALTERNATIVES

Sisig / atay (organ meat)	Grilled tuna (limit) or tofu sisig (tokwa-based) + egg
Dinuguan	Ginisang upo + pork shoulder (small serving, boiled, broth discarded)
Sardinas / dilis (snack)	Hard-boiled egg or tofu with calamansi + a little toyo
Bagoong in kare-kare	Miso paste (1 tsp) + calamansi — far lower purine, similar umami
Beer (after work)	Ice-cold black coffee / iced unsweetened calamansi juice / sparkling water
Coke / Pepsi with meals	Plain water + calamansi or brewed unsweetened tea
Bulalo broth / bone broth	Eat only the boiled beef (limited serving); skip all broth entirely
Kare-kare with bagnet + bagoong	Nilaga (boiled beef, no broth) + miso sauce instead of bagoong
Goto / goto-goto (organ-based)	Lugaw (plain rice porridge) with egg + ginger + no organ meats
Inihaw na bangus (whole portion)	Half portion (50-70g) tilapia or cream dory boiled + vegetables
Weekend beer-drinking session	One small glass of red wine maximum, with food; 2L water throughout day

THE FILIPINO "FLARE DAY" PATTERN — From the guide:

Saturday: beer + sisig + chicharon → Sunday: kare-kare + bagoong + lechon + softdrinks + isaw → dehydrated sleep

Monday 3AM: big toe on fire. THREE FIXES prevent 80% of these: stop softdrinks, stop beer, drink 2-3L water on weekends.

Full guide with UA calculator, FEUA tool, FAQ, medication guide & flare protocol:

williamriveromd.com/guides/gout-uric-acid.html